

LINKS GOLF MAJOR

July 16–19, 2026 · Southport, England · \$1,000 Bankroll · fully deployed (6 outright + 5 top-10 props)

🚩 **ROUND 2 UNDERWAY · FRI JUL 17 · UPDATED 2:55 PM UK (8:55 AM CT)**

Herbert may have just written himself into the record books. Yahoo's live-board headline now reads **Lucas Herbert "ties record for lowest score ever"** — pointing to a finished **8-under 62**, which would match Branden Grace's 62 (right here at Birkdale, 2017) as the lowest round in men's major history, capping the morning's record-tying 28 front nine. No verbatim final scoreboard line has syndicated yet, so we carry him as **leader at –8, round complete pending official board confirmation**. What IS confirmed by two agreeing sources: **Suber is in the clubhouse at –6** after a 1-under 69, draining a long par putt on 18 (Yahoo live blog + IBTimes) — two back. **Morikawa** last showed **–5 thru 9** (–2 today), best seat we own, three back — no fresher number syndicated this hour. **Koepka** (the 🌐 longshot) and **Fitzpatrick**: still no verified in-play numbers anywhere — overnight marks stand (**Koepka E, Fitzpatrick +2**, cut watch very much alive). Cut projection unchanged: **+1 most likely (~53%** per Yahoo's tracker; ~22% to +2) — Fitzpatrick still needs level or better. Afternoon wave imminent: **Scheffler (–2) off 3:04 PM** with Hatton and DeChambeau, **Rahm & Fleetwood (–1) together 3:15 PM UK** with Spieth — first live boards on our biggest stake at the next check.

156 players

FIELD · 4 ROUNDS

Royal Birkdale

FIRST OPEN HERE SINCE
2017

Scheffler

DEFENDING CHAMPION

R1 DONE

R2 FRIDAY FROM ~6:35 AM

🚩 **HOW THIS CARD WORKS — TWO-PHASE BUILD**

Golf majors settle over four days against a 156-man field — even the favorite is only ~15% to win, so an outright card is a **basket of longshots by nature**. Phase 1: \$600 across six outright, odds locked at build. Phase 2 (deployed Wednesday, before the first tee): **\$400 across five top-10 finish props** on our basket players — the higher-probability side of golf betting, where a top-10 cashes when our guy merely contends rather than has to win outright.

OUTRIGHT BOARD (DK / CONSENSUS AT BUILD)

Scottie Scheffler (def. champ)	+450	Rory McIlroy	+750
Jon Rahm	+1600	Tommy Fleetwood (Southport)	+1600
Xander Schauffele ('24 champ)	+1600	Matt Fitzpatrick	+2000
Cameron Young	+2500	Collin Morikawa ('21 champ)	+2800
Viktor Hovland	+3000	Brooks Koepka	+5000

THE ANGLES

SCHEFFLER +450 · THE ANCHOR

WORLD NO. 1 · DEFENDING OPEN CHAMPION

- ▶ Best player alive, though winless in 13 starts — the price got longer than his true chance
- ▶ Opened +400, drifted to +450; markets over-punish "droughts" for elite iron players
- ▶ Links golf rewards flushed irons + flighted wedges — his exact profile

Est. win: 18% vs ~15% market — the rare positive-EV favorite

FLEETWOOD +1600 · THE HOMETOWN STORY WITH TEETH

BORN IN SOUTHPORT — BIRKDALE IS LITERALLY HIS HOME COURSE

- ▶ Grew up playing Royal Birkdale; no player knows these dunes better
- ▶ Elite links pedigree: multiple top-fives in Opens, best ball-striking season of his career
- ▶ The narrative price and the golf price agree for once

Est. win: 7% vs 5.9% market

THE ENGLISH CONTINGENT

FITZPATRICK +2000 · HOME MAJOR MOTIVATION

- ▶ Fitzpatrick: three wins this season, best year of his career, home country major
- ▶ Knock: 94th in strokes-gained putting — links greens neutralize that gap
- ▶ Rahm +1600: two-time major champ, near-misses at both 2026 majors, built for wind

Rahm est. 7% · Fitzpatrick est. 5.5% — both above market

MORIKAWA + THE LONGSHOT

PROVEN OPEN WINNERS AT LONG PRICES

- ▶ Morikawa +2800: 2021 Open champion, just shot a Sunday 61 at Travelers
- ▶ Koepka +5000: five majors, big-game hunter, priced at career-long odds
- ▶ Majors are where Koepka's focus shows up — 50/1 is a stats-vs-narrative bet

Morikawa est. 4.5% · Koepka est. 2.5% — the 🌐 longshot lives here

\$1,000 BANKROLL ALLOCATION

TOTAL BUDGET

\$1,000

\$600 on 6 outright + \$400 on 5 top-10 props · fully deployed

BASKET COVERAGE

~44%

chance one of our six lifts the Claret Jug

★ PHASE 1 · OUTRIGHT WINNER BASKET (MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE — MAX ONE CASHES)

PICK	ODDS	STAKE	EST. WIN	TO WIN	TYPE
1 · Scottie Scheffler Defending champ · drought discount on the best player alive	+450	\$200	18% mkt 15%	+\$900.00	ANCHOR
2 · Jon Rahm Two majors · near-misses all season · wind player	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	+\$1,600.00	VALUE
3 · Tommy Fleetwood Southport native — Birkdale is his home course	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	+\$1,600.00	HOME TURF
4 · Matt Fitzpatrick 3 wins this season · English home major	+2000	\$80	5.5% mkt 4.8%	+\$1,600.00	VALUE
5 · Collin Morikawa 2021 Open champ · Sunday 61 at Travelers	+2800	\$70	4.5% mkt 3.4%	+\$1,960.00	VALUE
6 · 🌐 Brooks Koepka The longshot — 5 majors, career-long price, big-game DNA	+5000	\$50	2.5% mkt 2%	+\$2,500.00	LONGSHOT

PHASE 2 · TOP-10 PROPS · DEPLOYED WED JUL 15 · \$400

7 · Scottie Scheffler — Top 10 World No. 1 / +620 favorite · safest of the basket	-146	\$120	62% mkt 59%	+\$82.19	ANCHOR
8 · Tommy Fleetwood — Top 10 Southport native · Birkdale is his home links	+158	\$90	44% mkt 39%	+\$142.20	VALUE
9 · Jon Rahm — Top 10 Elite wind player · value vs the field	+172	\$80	42% mkt 37%	+\$137.60	VALUE
10 · Matt Fitzpatrick — Top 10 English · six straight cuts made at The Open	+164	\$70	42% mkt 38%	+\$114.80	VALUE
11 · Collin Morikawa — Top 10 2021 Open champ · elite ballstriker for links	+280	\$40	30% mkt 26%	+\$112.00	VALUE

Portfolio note. The six outright are mutually exclusive — at most one cashes, but any one of them pays for the entire card several times over (Scheffler +\$900 minimum, Koepka +\$2,500 maximum). Combined coverage: ~44% that one of ours wins the Jug. The \$400 Phase 2 deployment — five top-10 props across the basket — is the higher-probability hedge: a top-10 cashes when our guy contends, not only when he lifts the Jug. Scheffler's is near-even money; the other four carry plus-money value. **McIlroy +750 is our biggest deliberate fade** — playing too infrequently this year to trust at half Fleetwood's price.

ALLOCATION SUMMARY

\$1,000

FULLY DEPLOYED

11

BETS (6 + 5 PROPS)

~44%

BASKET COVERAGE

+\$2,500

BEST SINGLE PAYOUT

Fictitious \$1,000 bankroll test — no real money wagered. For entertainment purposes only.

Odds: DraftKings / consensus boards + Golf Digest reporting, locked at build (Sun Jul 12). Phase 2 props added Wednesday Jul 15. Settlement Sunday Jul 19 · tracked in betting_tracker.xlsx, tab "The Open".